Steven Atkinson, Ph.D.

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Senior Software Engineer ▪ AI-Centric Full-Stack Engineer

AI-centric Senior Software Engineer with over 11 years of experience at industry leaders such as Netflix, and as a founding engineer at LinkedIn. Directed both product and platform work, from user-facing web experiences to backend services. Spearheaded a core platform overhaul, boosting system speed by 50% and cutting incident occurrences by 20% within six months, with a 5x decrease in notification fatigue. Pioneered client-encryption protocols, achieving a leak-proof environment for credit card data. Defined and taught a master's-level AI course, doubling enrollment and receiving evaluations 5% above department standards. Awarded patents and recognized for technical excellence.

Core Competencies

Agent Workflows ▪ Anthropic/OpenAI APIs ▪ AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, EKS) ▪ CI/CD (GitHub Actions) ▪ Docker ▪ Event-Driven Architecture ▪ gRPC ▪ Hugging Face ▪ Java ▪ Kafka ▪ Kubernetes ▪ LangChain ▪ LLM Evaluation ▪ Microservices ▪ Node.js ▪ Observability (Prometheus, Grafana) ▪ PostgreSQL ▪ Prompt Engineering ▪ Python ▪ PyTorch ▪ RAG ▪ React ▪ Redis ▪ Release Engineering ▪ REST APIs ▪ Spring Boot ▪ SQL ▪ Terraform ▪ TypeScript ▪ Vector Databases

Professional Experience

CONSTELLIZE **2025-Present**

Founder

- Chartered Constellize, training 50+engineers on generative AI assistants, achieving demonstrably lower bug rates by integrating AI into the early development stages.
- Managed all sole proprietorship operations, including marketing, sales, and support, acquiring 50+ clients.

NETFLIX **2013-2026**

Senior Software Engineer, Central Platform Engineering **Jan 2024-Oct 2026**

- Owned the critical “fast properties” configuration service (200,000+ clients, 50,000+ requests/sec on AWS DynamoDB, Spring Boot), cutting publishing time 50% to 45 seconds for faster fleet-wide change visibility.
- Launched a new configuration wizard with a ‘deployment posture’ feature, cutting incidents 20% and time-in-wizard 25%.
- Instituted a property canary framework flagging the riskiest 1% of changes for immediate rollback, preventing cascade failures; identified three root causes of major outages and drove permanent fixes.
- Pioneered pre-flight risk assessment of code diffs, averting 10+ critical deployment failures, and built agentic plugins that cut LLM token usage 60%.
- Created the first incident analyzer across 6,000 incidents over 12 months, showing 40% of property changes helped rather than harmed; adopted by 4 other teams for toil and TV incident analysis.
- Led 18 engineers across 3 teams to bulk-delete 20%+ of configuration properties in under 6 months, and drove quarterly OKR planning for fast properties.

Senior Staff Engineer, DVD **Dec 2013-Jan 2024**

- Centralized website backend, reducing servers by 90%, and re-architected services to cut home page load time by 50%, enhancing customer experience, resilience and security.
- Saved $500K+ by eliminating legacy systems and consolidating databases to reduce data center footprint.
- Orchestrated team effort, resulting in a record operating margin of 70%, enhancing business efficiency amid challenges like a declining customer base, content adjustments, and rising postage costs.
- Reduced traffic to sensitive endpoints by 90% by leading site security enhancements.
- Slashed traffic to streaming services by 60%+ via innovative approaches to customer recognition and log-in.
- Reduced home page time-to-box shots from 3.4 seconds to 500ms-1500ms by leading development and design of merchandising server with a caching strategy and sticky-cookie client that would scale to millions of users.

LALO **2021-2022**

Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

- Architected and scaled backend service from 100 to 2,000+ customers, restructuring the MVP to increase capacity by 20X while introducing new features.
- Collaborated with founder on MVP and roadmap, defining strategic goals and establishing company objectives.
- Conceived, implemented, and deployed secure multimedia retrieval system, encrypting 10,000+ memories at rest and in transit, while ensuring great user experience with faster sub-2-second retrieval.
- Crafted engineering sections for 10+ investor updates, providing confidence in scalability during growth phases.
- Led nine individuals across React Native, Java server, and AWS teams, facilitating efficient product development.

TENEFIT **2011-2013**

Principal Software Engineer

- Earned two patents for leveraging proprietary WebSocket extensions, incorporating in-band protocol for WebSocket re-authorization, and enhancing security through closed firewalls.
- Established plugin single-sign-on solution for native web sockets, ensuring retention of two significant customers with variations in identity management schemes.

Education

The University of Queensland, Brisbane, Australia

Ph.D., Computer Science and Electrical Engineering

- Recipient, University of Queensland Medal

Bachelor of Information Technology, First Class Honours